UBS Luxury Property Focus

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Chief Investment Office GWM | Investment research

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UBS Luxury Property Focus
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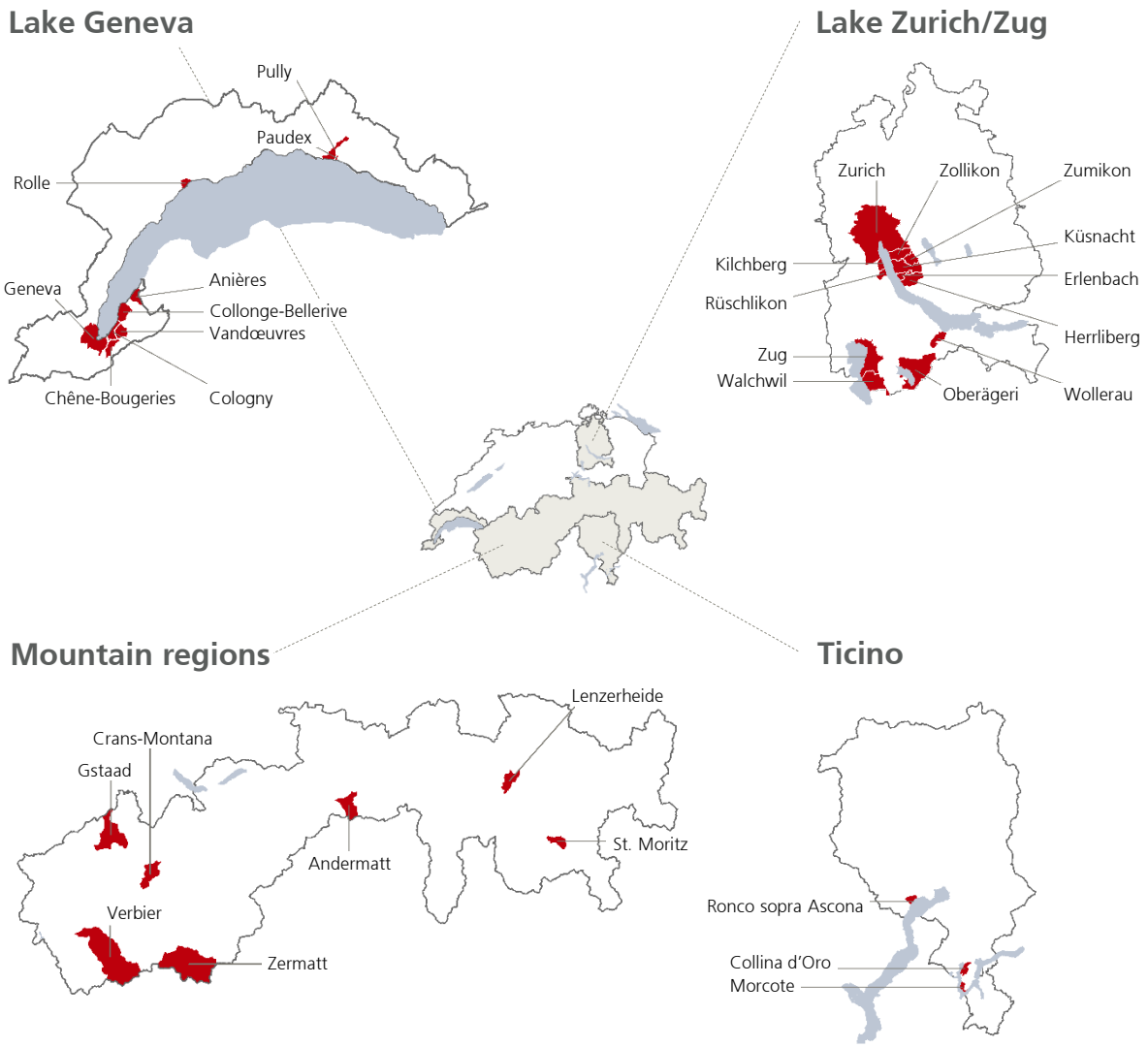
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Locations

The word "luxury" was originally viewed negatively and was considered a synonym for excess and waste. Over time, the meaning has changed: Today, luxury increasingly stands for prosperity and describes the exclusive and unique beyond what is necessary. Luxury real estate has become a status symbol and is therefore defined not only by price but also by size and quality of finish.

Our analysis covers 31 Swiss municipalities that we classify as luxury locations. These have been divided into four regions: Lake Zurich/Zug, Lake Geneva, the Alpine region, and Ticino. However, luxury properties can also be found sporadically in other municipalities.



Prices

Highest prices in the mountain regions

St. Moritz (GR) is the most exclusive and expensive luxury real estate location in Switzerland, with average prices of around CHF 52,000 per square meter. Gstaad (BE) and Verbier (VS) are two other top Alpine destinations, with average luxury segment prices of about CHF 45,000 per square meter.

The highest prices outside the mountain regions are achieved in Cologny (GE) on Lake Geneva, with an average of CHF 43,000 per square meter. Other Geneva municipalities with a high share of luxury properties reach prices of around CHF 30,000 per square meter. In the lakeside municipalities of Vaud, the price level is about CHF 25,000 per square meter.

On Lake Zurich, the highest prices are achieved in Küsnacht (ZH), with an average of CHF 37,000 per square meter. In the other lakeside municipalities and in the canton of Zug, prices range between CHF 30,000 and CHF 35,000. In the Ticino locations, the price level in the luxury segment typically ranges from CHF 20,000 to CHF 25,000 per square meter.

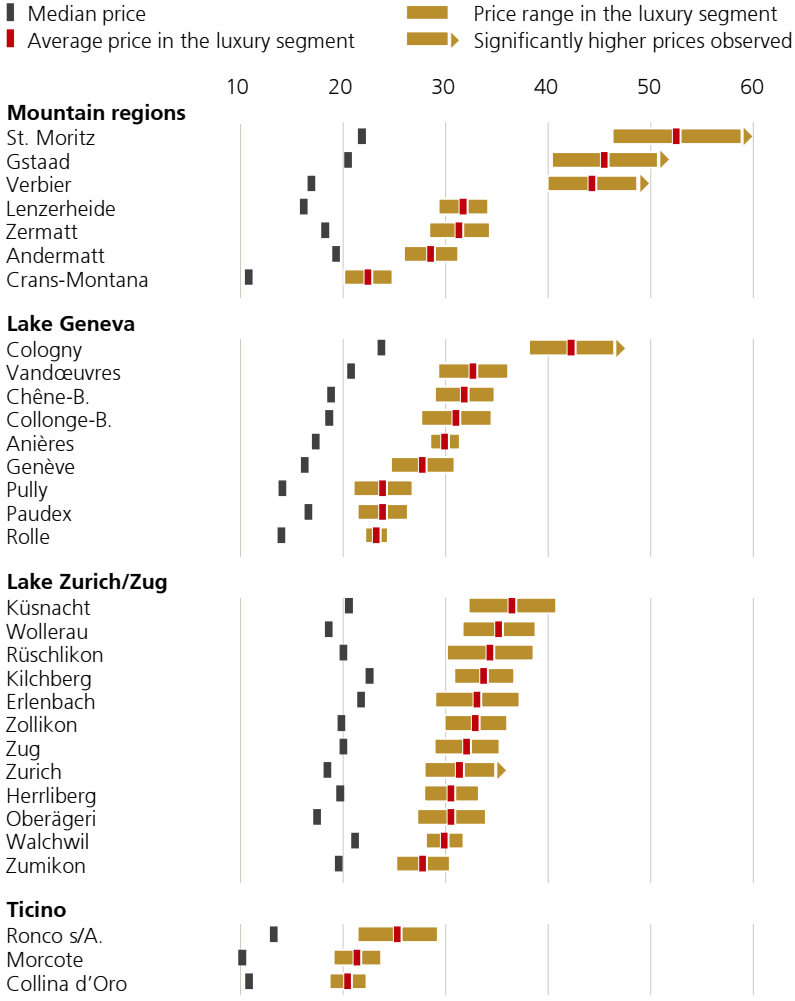
Upper price range virtually unlimited

The stated price level refers to above-average-sized condominiums and single-family homes with outstanding quality of finish in attractive to prime neighborhoods. The values roughly correspond to the 95th percentile of prices paid in each respective municipality.

At the very top end, transaction prices can materially exceed municipal averages. For example, in St. Moritz and Gstaad, prices of over CHF 100,000 per square meter are occasionally achieved.

Home prices

at the end of 2025, in thousands of CHF per square meter



Source: UBS; see Methodology & Sources on page 12

Outlook

The luxury market in Switzerland is overall manageable: Each year, probably fewer than 500 transactions take place, with more than 80% accounted for by condominiums. Even a small change on the demand side can therefore be enough to noticeably move the market. A local boom in high-value-added industries or the arrival of just a few very wealthy individuals to a region is often sufficient to drive prices up significantly. The price level, especially in absolute top locations, is therefore not set in stone but is subject to considerable fluctuations.

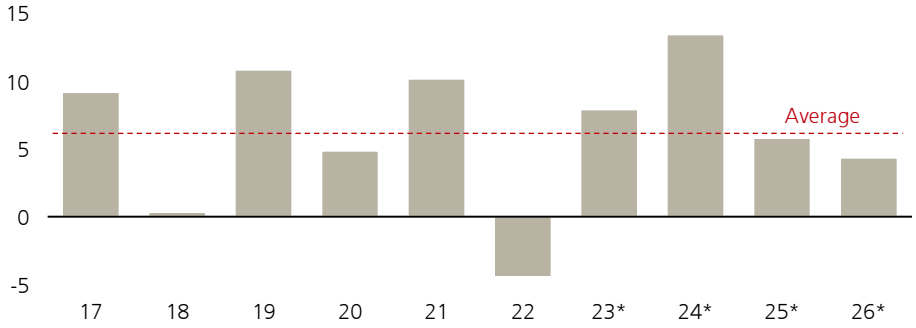
Wealth boom drives willingness to pay

In 2025, the price of luxury properties in the municipalities we analyzed increased by an average of 3.2%. This represents a slowdown compared to the previous year and is also somewhat weaker than the price trend in the overall owner-occupied housing market. In absolute terms last year, luxury condominiums saw stronger price gains than the more expensive single-family homes.

On average over the past five years, prices have risen by just under 4.7% per year. A key price driver was the strong performance of financial markets in recent years. As a result, wealth increased and, with it, the willingness to pay for high-priced real estate. There are about 50% more taxpayers in Switzerland with assets of over CHF 10mn today than there were in 2019.

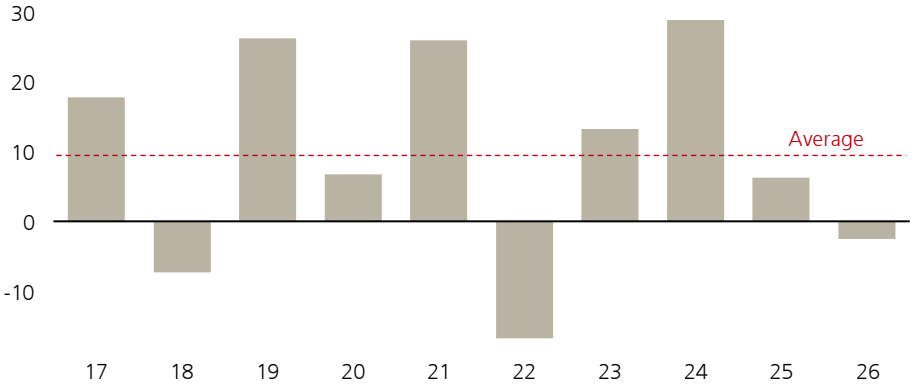
Multimillionaires

Change in the number of taxpayers in Switzerland with assets of at least CHF 10 million, year over year, in %



Equity markets

Annual total return of the MSCI World Gross Total Return Index in CHF, in %; 2026: Return in the 1st quarter.



*UBS estimates from 2023 and UBS forecasts for 2026
Sources: Bloomberg, SNB, UBS

Domestic demand as a brake, geopolitics as support

The number of jobs in high-value-added industries declined last year. The still subdued outlook for the Swiss economy this year therefore offers little impetus for domestic demand for luxury real estate. The further increase in price levels also narrows the pool of potential buyers.

For foreign investors, Swiss real estate has become about 60% more expensive since 2019 when calculated in euros or US dollars. This does dampen demand, but the expectation of a long-term appreciation of the Swiss franc and further real estate price gains are likely to offset this effect. In times of geopolitical uncertainty, Switzerland is also becoming more attractive to buyers from abroad.

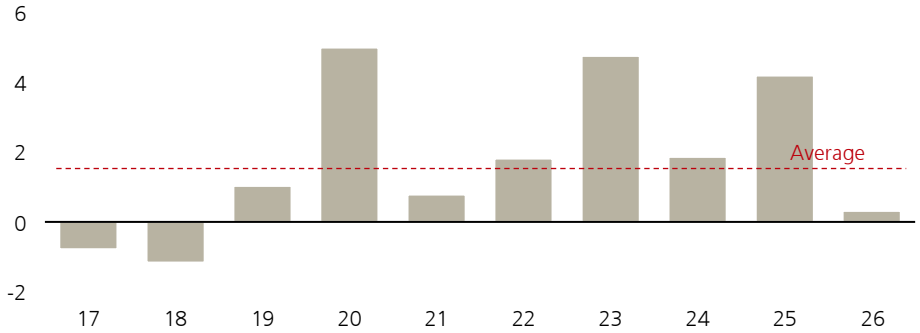
Lower price increases expected

The moderate listing duration in the luxury market currently points to a solid market base. However, the weak economy and declining affordability of luxury condominiums in the mid-single-digit-millions range suggest a calmer development than in recent years. We expect price increases of less than 2%—meaning the luxury market is unlikely to keep pace with the broader owner-occupied housing market in 2026.

The biggest risks to a declining willingness to pay are a prolonged bear market in equities and an economic recession. A tightening of the so-called Lex Koller (Swiss law restricting foreign ownership of real estate) could also destabilize the market.

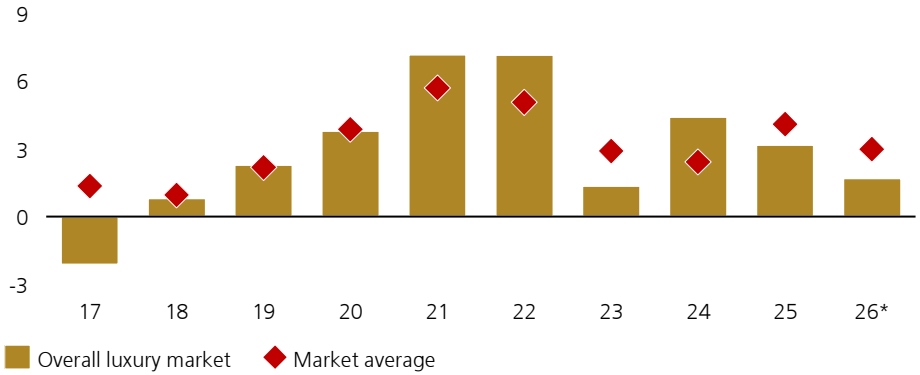
Exchange rate

Average year-over-year change in the CHF exchange rate against the USD and EUR, in %; 2026: as of the end of March compared with December 2025, positive value = appreciation



Price development

In the luxury segment and in the market average (according to the UBS Composite Index), in % compared to the previous year



*UBS forecasts for 2026
Sources: SNB, UBS; see Methodology & Sources on page 12



Mountain regions

The price boom has continued in the past year. On average across locations, luxury properties are now around 40% more expensive than they were five years ago. No other region in Switzerland has recorded such strong price gains.

The luxury market in St. Moritz, Verbier, and Gstaad is shaped by foreign investors with low price sensitivity. Switzerland's prime locations are sought after given the strong currency, attractive tax policies, and a high level of safety and anonymity in everyday life. A vacation home in the mountains is increasingly viewed as an investment asset. In destinations with predominantly domestic second-home demand, both absolute price levels and price growth are significantly more moderate.

Appreciation of the Swiss franc and high prices are not deterring foreign investors—particularly against the backdrop of geopolitical turmoil. We therefore do not expect a trend reversal at the most prime locations for the time being.

Price change

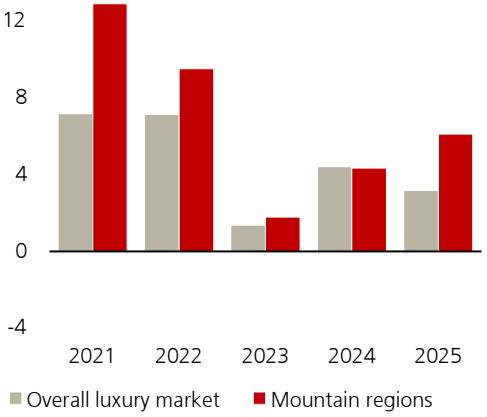
2025
6.1%

5 years
39%

10 years
32%

Price development

Luxury segment, in percent year over year



Overview

Location	Prices in the luxury segment			Market size and liquidity			Tax burden	
Municipality	Average	Apartments 150 m²	Villas 200 m²	Luxury listings	Luxury villas	Listing duration	Income CHF 500k	Assets CHF 10mn
	CHF/m2	*CHF mn*	*CHF mn*	*% of total*	*% of luxury*	*overall, days*	*%*	*‰*
St. Moritz	53 000	6.7	15.8	42	25	120	20.9	2.5
Gstaad	46 000	7.0	9.0	60	50	158	26.7	5.1
Verbier	44 000	5.7	9.8	28	60	131	26.9	6.0
Lenzerheide	32 000	3.6	7.0	13	70	92	22,2	2.8
Zermatt	31 000	4.7	6.6	51	20	148	26.9	6.0
Andermatt	29 000	4.3	4.5	35	5	133	19.8	2.0
Crans-Montana	23 000	3.5	4.4	20	40	173	28.2	6.4

Source: UBS; see Methodology & Sources on page 12



Lake Geneva

Demand remains robust overall and new construction activity is limited. The success of commodities trading firms is supporting willingness to pay for luxury properties. In addition, budget cuts at international organizations have so far had little negative impact on demand. However, luxury properties offered for sale currently take somewhat longer to be sold successfully than the median property.

The strongly international market for luxury properties has recorded solid, albeit below-average, price increases in recent years overall. Price levels are currently just over 2% above those seen last year and nearly 15% higher than in 2020. A price plateau has recently been reached in prime locations around Lake Geneva. However, we expect somewhat stronger demand from the Middle East to lead to renewed upward price pressure.

Price change

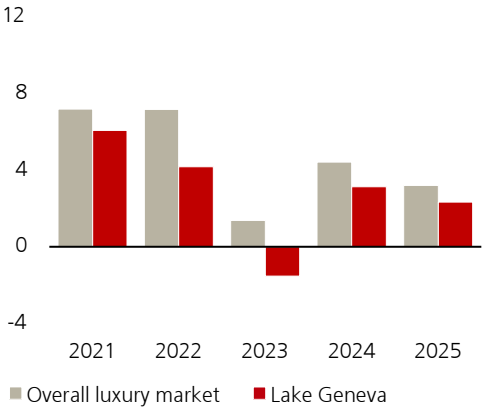
2025
2.3%

5 years
15%

10 years
19%

Price development

Luxury segment, in percent year over year



Overview

Location	Prices in the luxury segment			Market size and liquidity			Tax burden	
Municipality	Average	Apartments 150 m²	Villas 200 m²	Luxury listings	Luxury villas	Listing duration	Income CHF 500k	Assets CHF 10mn
	CHF/m2	*CHF mn*	*CHF mn*	*% of total*	*% of luxury*	*overall, days*	*%*	*‰*
Cologny	42 000	4.1	9.7	55	70	159	25.7	7.2
Vandœuvres	33 000	4.6	6.8	53	70	192	25.9	7.3
Chêne-B.	32 000	3.9	7.0	46	70	159	26.5	7.5
Collonge-B.	31 000	3.6	6.5	44	90	128	26.1	7.3
Anières	30 000	3.2	6.2	44	90	192	26.4	7.4
Geneva	28 000	4.1	6.6	30	15	138	28.0	8.0
Pully	24 000	3.6	4.8	17	40	151	29.0	7.2
Paudex	24 000	3.5	4.9	73	45	197	29.5	7.4
Rolle	23 000	3.5	4.8	16	55	212	28.8	7.1

Source: UBS; see Methodology & Sources on page 12



Lake Zurich / Zug

Demand for luxury residential property is driven primarily by high-income expats. In 2025, weaker employment growth in the Zurich region noticeably dampened demand, while momentum in the Zug area continued. Prices in the luxury segment rose by 2.8% and now stand nearly 30% above the 2020 level.

The marketing period for luxury properties currently corresponds to the market average. At Lake Zurich, a noticeable expansion in supply is expected due to building permits, which currently correspond to 1.5% of the owner-occupied housing stock.

Asking prices have recently been increasingly scrutinized in the transaction market. In view of weak economic conditions, willingness to pay for luxury properties is likely to stagnate, making price increases overall rather unlikely in the current year.

Price change

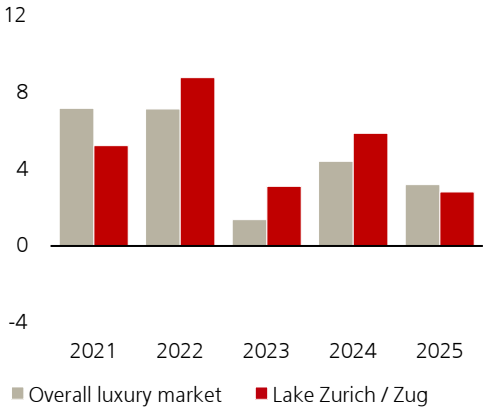
2025
2.8%

5 years
28%

10 years
44%

Price development

Luxury segment, in percent year over year



Overview

Location	Prices in the luxury segment			Market size and liquidity			Tax burden	
Municipality	Average	Apartments 150 m²	Villas 200 m²	Luxury listings	Luxury villas	Listing duration	Income CHF 500k	Assets CHF 10mn
	CHF/m2	*CHF mn*	*CHF mn*	*% of total*	*% of luxury*	*overall, days*	*%*	*‰*
Küsnacht	37 000	4.6	8.7	35	50	166	22.2	4.4
Wollerau	35 000	4.6	7.8	54	55	151	13.8	1.1
Rüschlikon	34 000	4.4	8.4	37	40	186	22.4	4.5
Kilchberg	34 000	5.1	6.7	45	30	135	22.1	4.4
Erlenbach	33 000	4.4	7,3	37	55	155	22.4	4.5
Zollikon	33 000	4.5	7.4	25	45	161	22.4	4.5
Zug	32 000	4.8	6.7	37	30	104	15.8	2.1
Zurich	31 000	4.3	7.6	21	30	140	26.0	5.6
Herrliberg	31 000	4.1	7.0	39	45	168	22.4	4.5
Oberägeri	31 000	4.0	6.8	32	55	164	15.9	2.1
Walchwil	30 000	4.2	6.3	59	60	133	15.9	2.1
Zumikon	28 000	3.7	6.1	27	55	168	22.4	4.5

Source: UBS; see Methodology & Sources on page 12



Ticino

Luxury properties in Ticino have risen in value less strongly than the market average in recent years. Prices stagnated last year.

The most important demand groups are, on the one hand, financially strong newcomers from Italy who value the high quality of life and safety standards. On the other hand, the market in the Ascona region is strongly shaped by demand for second homes from German-speaking countries. The solid development of the Lugano financial center is also indirectly generating additional demand for high-priced properties.

However, anyone wishing to sell a luxury property under time pressure must expect price discounts. The luxury residential property market in southern Switzerland shows long listing durations: in many cases, a listed property is sold only after more than a year. This is likely to prevent stronger price momentum for the time being.

Price change

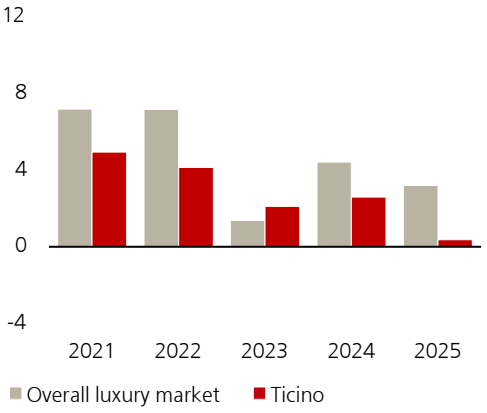
2025
0.3%

5 years
15%

10 years
11%

Price development

Luxury segment, in percent year over year



Overview

Location	Prices in the luxury segment			Market size and liquidity			Tax burden	
Municipality	Average	Apartments 150 m²	Villas 200 m²	Luxury listings	Luxury villas	Listing duration	Income CHF 500k	Assets CHF 10mn
	CHF/m2	*CHF mn*	*CHF mn*	*% of total*	*% of luxury*	*overall, days*	*%*	*‰*
Ronco s/A.	25 000	3.5	5.6	34	50	153	26.5	4.4
Morcote	21 000	2.8	4.6	23	65	183	27.0	4.5
Collina d'Oro	21 000	2.6	5.0	21	45	184	24.9	4.0

Source: UBS; see Methodology & Sources on page 12

International

St. Moritz tops the list with an average price in its luxury market of USD 66,500 per square meter. Monaco, the only market among the top five outside the mountain regions, ranks second with prices above USD 62,000. Aspen (USD 61,100) is third on the global list. Gstaad (USD 57,700) and Verbier (USD 55,900) complete the top five, underscoring Switzerland's leading position in the international comparison. The strong Swiss franc has further supported these rankings.

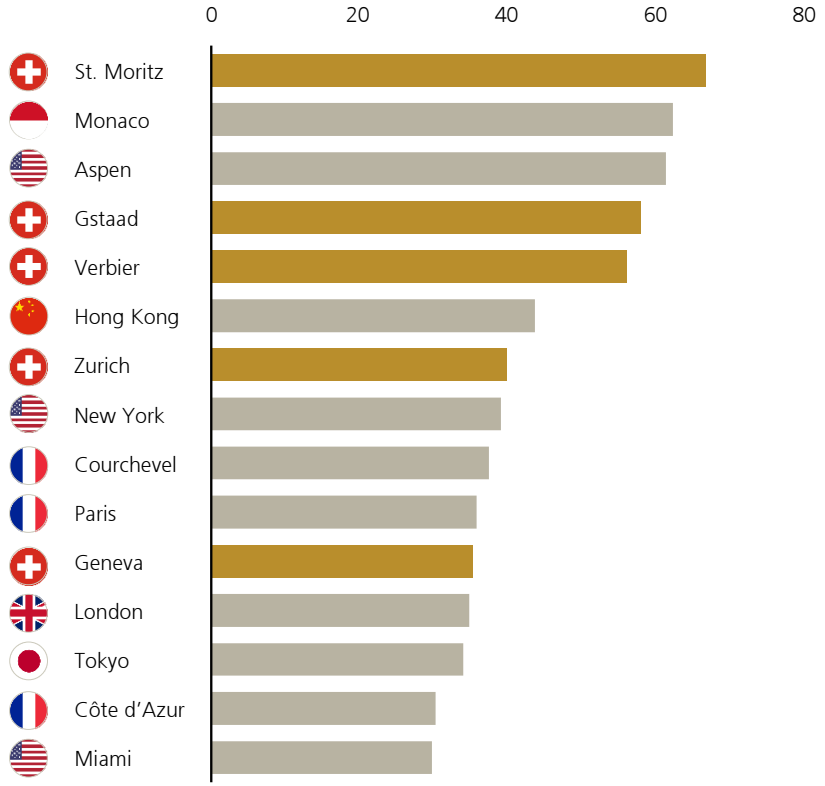
Among cities, Hong Kong is the most expensive Asian destination at USD 43,600 per square meter, while buyers of luxury real estate in Manhattan face the highest prices among US cities (an average of USD 39,000).

Established luxury locations back in focus

According to real estate service providers Savills and Knight Frank, prices in global luxury real estate markets rose by an average of 2.1% in 2025. This marks a slowdown compared to 2024 and is below the average for Swiss luxury markets. The strongest price increases in 2025 were recorded in the Middle East.

Global demand for luxury properties is likely to increasingly focus again on established luxury locations with tax advantages, high political stability, and strong security standards. Switzerland thus remains a magnet for international buyers in the luxury segment.

Luxury home prices
Average levels in select markets, in thousands of US dollars per square meter



Source: UBS estimate based on various internet sources

Methodology & Sources

Price level and development

The reported price level in each municipality is based on an estimate incorporating asking prices, transaction prices, and modeled property values. The figures roughly correspond to the 95th percentile of prices paid in the respective municipality for above-average-sized condominiums and single-family homes with high-end finishes in good to very good micro-locations (neighborhoods).

The ranges shown on page 4 reflect location and quality differences in the luxury segment. Median prices were calculated exclusively on the basis of listings. All area figures refer to net living space.

Regional price development is derived from an average of transaction and asking prices. Assessments by local market experts are also incorporated for the past year and the outlook. Price development in the Swiss luxury market represents a weighted average of the regions.

Prices for individual properties may deviate significantly from the reported values. Price performance can also differ substantially in individual cases.

Sources: FPRE, IAZI, Wüest Partner, UBS

Market size and liquidity

There are no official statistics on the number of luxury properties; the results presented here are based on UBS estimates.

The relevance of the luxury residential property market in individual municipalities is determined based on the number of listed high-priced properties as a share of total listings over the past two years. Depending on the municipality, a local threshold value for the minimum price in the luxury market is applied. Properties without a stated price are allocated to the luxury segment.

The share of single-family homes (villas and chalets) in the stock of luxury properties is also estimated on the basis of listings from the past two years and supplemented with UBS internal transaction data.

Days on market indicate the median number of days during which listed properties remain on the market, regardless of price segment.

Sources: FSO, FPRE, UBS

Tax burden

The Swiss tax system for private individuals is organized on a federal basis and varies significantly by canton and municipality.

The tax burden shown in the regional tables refers to a gross employment income of CHF 500,000 and net assets of CHF 10 million for a married couple without children with approximately equal incomes. The data refer to 2025.

Wealthy foreign nationals not engaged in gainful employment in Switzerland can, in many cantons, be taxed on a lump-sum basis (expenditure-based taxation). Among the luxury destinations considered in this study, only the canton of Zurich does not offer lump-sum taxation.

Sources: FTA, UBS

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